

Typography in CSS

Control fonts, sizing, spacing, alignment, and readability to create clear and polished web interfaces.

What Is Typography?

Typography is how text appears on a web page — its font, size, spacing, alignment, weight, and overall readability. Good typography improves user experience and design quality.

Basic Text Properties

1. font-family

Sets the typeface for your text. You can specify a list of fallback fonts.

Always end with a generic family like **sans-serif**, **serif**, or **monospace**.

Common font stacks

```
body {  
  font-family: Arial, sans-serif;  
}  
  
font-family: "Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;  
font-family: Georgia, 'Times New Roman', serif;  
font-family: 'Courier New', Courier, monospace;
```

2. font-size

Controls the size of the text. You can use units like **px**, **em**, **rem**, and **%**.

```
h1 {  
  font-size: 36px;  
}  
  
p {  
  font-size: 1.2rem;  
}
```

Font Weight & Style

Use font weight and style to control emphasis and the visual character of text.

3. font-weight

Defines the boldness of text. You can use keywords like **normal**, **bold**, or numeric values like 100, 400, 700, and 900.

```
strong {  
  font-weight: bold;  
}
```

4. font-style

Sets text to normal, italic, or oblique.

```
em {  
  font-style: italic;  
}
```

Quick Reference

Property	Purpose
font-family	Sets the typeface and fallback font stack.
font-size	Controls the size of text.
font-weight	Controls the boldness of text.
font-style	Sets normal, italic, or oblique text.

■ Tip

Use a sensible fallback stack so text remains readable even when the preferred font is unavailable.

Text Alignment & Spacing

Fine-tune the rhythm and alignment of text for comfortable reading.

5. text-align

Aligns text horizontally.

Values: **left**, **right**, **center**, **justify**.

```
h2 {  
  text-align: center;  
}
```

6. line-height

Controls the space between lines of text. This improves readability, especially for paragraphs.

```
p {  
  line-height: 1.6;  
}
```

7. letter-spacing

Controls space between characters.

```
h1 {  
  letter-spacing: 2px;  
}
```

8. word-spacing

Controls space between words.

```
p {  
  word-spacing: 5px;  
}
```

Text Transformation & Decoration

Change text case and control visual decorations such as underlines, overlines, and line-through.

9. text-transform

Changes the case of text.

Value	Effect
uppercase	Converts text to uppercase.
lowercase	Converts text to lowercase.
capitalize	Capitalizes the first letter of each word.

```
.upper {  
  text-transform: uppercase;  
}  
  
.lower {  
  text-transform: lowercase;  
}  
  
.capitalize {  
  text-transform: capitalize;  
}
```

10. text-decoration

Controls underlining, overlining, and line-through.

```
a {  
  text-decoration: none;  
}
```

Using Google Fonts

To use custom fonts, you can load them from Google Fonts.

```
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Roboto&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">  
  
body {  
  font-family: 'Roboto', sans-serif;  
}
```

Typography Summary

A compact reference for creating readable and consistent text.

Key Properties

Property	Key idea
font-family	Choose the typeface and provide fallbacks.
font-size	Control the size of text.
font-weight	Control text boldness.
font-style	Set normal, italic, or oblique text.
text-align	Align text horizontally.
line-height	Control vertical space between lines.
letter-spacing	Control space between characters.
word-spacing	Control space between words.
text-transform	Change the case of text.
text-decoration	Control text decorations.

Best Practices

- Use **rem** for font sizing to keep things scalable.
- Set appropriate **line-height** and **font-family** for comfortable reading.
- Align and style text to match your design's personality.

■ Quick Takeaway

Typography affects the readability and tone of your website. Use scalable sizing, comfortable line-height, suitable font families, and deliberate alignment and spacing.